



Chat from inside your Web site

ability to hold group chats, calling up contacts—you get all the goodies.

Visitor Map: Find out where your visitors come from, on a Google map. The map uses an API from Clicky (www.getclicky.com), a Web analytics service. To



Check your visitor's locations

use this gadget, register your site at Clicky, then go to the Google Gadgets page and get the HTML code. There is a slight bug here—till Clicky gets enough visitor statistics, the map shows the default image.

For lighting up the mood, we put in the English to Yoda speak converter (we love *Star Wars*, and we love the little Jedi master most). Type in any English sentence—"Work is a pain in the neck"—and a few seconds later, up pops up, in Yoda speak: "Pain in the neck work is. Yes, hmmm". (A swear word elicits a scolding.)

Google Maps: Inserting maps, even if you have no experience with code, is very easy with Google maps. To create a custom map, you need to go to Google Maps, select My Maps, click on Create New Map and start dragging placeholders and drawing lines and shapes on your map. When you're done, click on Link To This Page at the top right of the map, and get the HTML code.

Flickr Zeitgeist: This is a small widget to display your photos from Flickr, if you have any uploaded there. Visit

www.flickr.com/fun/zeitgeist/ to get your HTML code.

Of course, you don't have to settle for what's already there...

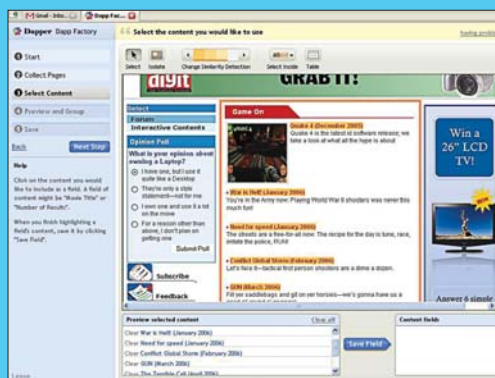
Your Own Gadget

Making your own Google gadget is surprisingly easy—you just need to have an idea of what are you going to "gadgetise," and a few clicks later, you've got yourself a brand new gadget. As we've mentioned later, you won't immediately be allowed to put your gadget on your Blogger page, but it's a start.

Start with a site whose contents you want to see in the gadget—we chose www.thinkdigit.com. Open www.dapper.net, a site that allows you to take content off any page and transform it into a variety of formats like XML, RSS feeds, Google Gadgets, Netvibes Modules, etc. Choose Google gadgets.

When you put in www.thinkdigit.com in the address bar, Dapper opens a frame with the site in it. Navigate to the *Game On* section under *Digital Leisure*. Click on Add to Basket to add this section to your gadget.

Choose the fields using the Select arrow at the top. The fields that will go in your Dapp are highlighted in yellow. This is a bit tricky, as the yellow patches have a way of getting on unwanted content like ads or links. If you don't select



Select the content which you want

well, your Dapp (applications made with Dapper) will be worthless. Give a common name to your group of content—we selected "Game Reviews."



Your selected content, in a list

Click Next to view the content that has been selected. Here, we've got a list of the games that have been reviewed in the magazine. This list will now be updated when the site is.



Name your gadget, and get a preview



Your gadget, on your iGoogle page

The final step is saving your Dapp—name, describe and tag it, then click Save. If you're unsure of whether your Dapp works right, check the This is a test Dapp box—the Dapp will be deleted within 24 hours. Alternatively, if you don't want your Dapp published in Dapper's directory, check the Make Private option. After hitting Save, you'll get to make some final settings, and also preview your gadget. You can add it to your iGoogle page, or publish it in the iGoogle directory.

Only if (and this is a big if) your gadget gets listed in the Google directory will you be able to add it to your Blogger page. Google takes its own time, so it's best to remain content with adding the gadget to your iGoogle page.

Conclusion

There you go: a basic guide to making your own Web 2.0 mash-up, with a mini primer on Google Gadgets. Go ahead and surf the Google Gadgets directory—there are so many gadgets available, you can have one for every conceivable need.

Making a mash-up (most people define Web 2.0 their own way, so the definition of "Web 2.0 mash-up" varies) is fun, and also makes for a slick site, if tastefully done. ☐

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